Season 4: The Final Season

Attack on Titan - Detailed Season Summary (Marley, War for Paradis, the Rumbling and the Final Chapters)

Season: 4 (The Final Season, in several parts) | **Original run:** December 2020 - November 2023

Story arcs: Marley arc, War for Paradis, Beginning of the Rumbling, The Final Chapters (Alliance, Rumbling, ending)

Key characters: Eren Yeager, Mikasa Ackerman, Armin Arlert, Reiner Braun, Gabi Braun, Falco Grice, Zeke Yeager, Annie Leonhart, Levi, Hange Zoe, Ymir Fritz

Spoiler warning: this document summarises the anime in full, including major twists and the ending of the season described.

1. Season Overview

Season 4, titled The Final Season, is the last and by far the longest season of Attack on Titan. It was released in several parts: Part 1 (the Marley arc), Part 2 (the War for Paradis and the beginning of the Rumbling) and The Final Chapters, which concluded the series in two special episodes. The season begins four years after the events of Season 3 and takes the story outside the walls for the first time. It shifts perspectives, showing the world from the point of view of the supposed enemies, and then follows Eren's plan, which leads to a catastrophic event called the Rumbling and a final battle that decides the fate of both Eldia and the world.

2. Major Characters in Season 4

Eren Yeager is now the Attack Titan and later the Founding Titan, and his motives become the central mystery. **Mikasa Ackerman** and **Armin Arlert** try to stop him. **Reiner Braun** returns as a haunted soldier. **Gabi Braun** and **Falco Grice** are young Marleyan soldiers who learn to see the people they were taught to hate. **Zeke Yeager** is the Beast Titan and Eren's half-brother. **Pieck Finger** and **Porco Galliard** are fellow Warriors. **Annie Leonhart** eventually wakes from her crystal. **Levi Ackerman**, **Hange Zoe**, **Jean Kirstein** and **Connie Springer** fight on. **Sasha Braus** dies during this season. **Floch Forster** becomes the leader of the Yeagerists. **Willy Tybur** is the public face of Marley's war effort. **Yelena** and **Onyankopon** are members of the Anti-Marleyan Volunteers who help the heroes. **Grisha Yeager** appears in memories, and **Ymir Fritz**, the origin of all Titans, plays a crucial role in the finale.

3. Detailed Plot Summary - Part 1: The Marley Arc

Arc 1 - Marley and the Warriors

Four years after the discovery of the basement, the story begins in Marley, the militaristic nation outside the walls. It is at war with the Mid-East Allied Forces, and Marley depends on its Titan shifters, called Warriors, to keep its dominance. Eldians in Marley live in segregated internment zones and are treated as second-class citizens. Reiner Braun, who is suffering from trauma, serves as the Armored Titan. Gabi Braun and Falco Grice, children of Eldian families, train to become the next Warriors. The war is won when Zeke's Beast Titan destroys the enemy fleet, but it shows that Marley is ruthless and that the Eldians are used as weapons.

Arc 2 - The Liberio Attack

Marley decides to invade Paradis Island to take the Founding Titan. At the same time, Eren and members of the Survey Corps, including Armin, Mikasa, Connie and Jean, cross the sea and secretly enter Marley. Eren stands in the crowd at a public event where Willy Tybur, the head of the Tybur family, announces that Marley will crush Paradis. Eren attacks, kills Willy and fights the Warhammer Titan. He eats the Warhammer Titan's wielder and gains its power. Many innocent people die in the chaos, and Eren becomes a symbol of terror to the world. The attack makes open war between Marley and Paradis unavoidable.

Arc 3 - Sasha's Death and Battles on the Island

After the attack, the survivors flee by airship, with Gabi and Falco hiding aboard. In a tragic moment, Gabi shoots and kills Sasha, a loss that devastates her friends. Gabi and Falco are taken to Paradis as prisoners and for the first time meet the people they were taught to hate. They discover that they are not monsters but ordinary people, and that some are kind to them. Reiner and the Warriors struggle with guilt, and the Alliance of the Survey Corps's survivors starts to question whether they can ever stop the cycle of hatred.

4. Detailed Plot Summary - Part 2: The War for Paradis and the Beginning of the Rumbling

Arc 4 - Eren and the Yeagerists

Back on Paradis, Eren is jailed for acting against the Survey Corps's orders, while Zeke is held as a prisoner. A group of young soldiers who admire Eren, led by Floch Forster, form the Yeagerist faction and begin to take control of the island. Floch and his allies stage a coup, imprison Queen Historia and place the government under their control. Eren seemingly breaks all ties with Mikasa and Armin and appears to be planning something terrible.

Arc 5 - Marley's Counterattack

Marley sends its fleet to Paradis, and the Warriors, now fighting for their own survival, take part in the invasion. Eren, freed by the Yeagerists, fights the Armored Titan and Marley's forces. Pieck's Cart Titan and Porco's Jaw Titan attack as well. In the confusion, Eren and Zeke meet and the two touch, activating a link between them in the Paths, a mysterious dimension that connects all Eldians. Inside the Paths, the two brothers view Grisha's memories and explore the nature of the Founding Titan.

Arc 6 - The Paths and the Rumbling Begins

In the Paths, Zeke expects that Eren will use the Founding Titan to carry out his plan of Eldian euthanasia, a plan to prevent any more Eldians from being born so that the Titan curse ends peacefully. But Eren reveals that he has been manipulating events across time. By sending memories to his father Grisha, Eren pushed him to kill the royal family and obtain the Founding Titan. With the power of the Founding Titan he reaches Ymir Fritz, the origin of all Titans, and he calls on the Colossal Titans trapped in the walls to begin the Rumbling. As the walls collapse, thousands of Colossal Titans march across the sea toward the rest of the world. Eren declares that he will destroy all life outside Paradis to protect his homeland.

5. Detailed Plot Summary - The Final Chapters

Arc 7 - The Alliance

In The Final Chapters, the survivors of the Survey Corps (Mikasa, Armin, Jean, Connie, Levi and Hange) and the former Warriors (Reiner, Pieck, and later Annie, along with Gabi and Falco) form an Alliance to stop Eren. They are helped by Magath, the Marleyan general, and Onyankopon, and by the Azumabito

family from Hizuru, who provide an aircraft. The Alliance fights the Yeagerists at the port, then sails after the Rumbling. Along the way they must decide whether killing Eren is the only way to stop the destruction. Mikasa, who still loves Eren, grapples with the question of whether she can do it.

Arc 8 - The Race to Stop the Rumbling

The Alliance reaches the Rumbling as Eren, in the form of the colossal Founding Titan, destroys cities and kills millions. Marley's navy and air force try to stop him with bombs, but the Titans simply crush them. The Alliance fights its way toward Eren through swarms of Titans. Hange sacrifices herself to hold back the Titans, and Levi, badly injured, keeps fighting. Mikasa and Levi work together to break through Eren's defences, and Mikasa realises that Eren himself is hidden in the mouth of the Attack Titan, not at its nape.

Arc 9 - The Final Confrontation

Inside the Paths, Armin speaks with Eren. Eren admits that he did everything to protect his friends and that he wants them to defeat him so that they will be seen as saviours of the world. Armin and Eren speak in the Paths, and Armin cannot talk him out of it. Armin and Mikasa work together; Mikasa, understanding what Eren wants, decapitates him and ends the Rumbling. When Eren dies, the Titan power disappears and the Eldians permanently lose the ability to transform. Ymir Fritz, free after two thousand years of servitude, finally rests, and the world begins to rebuild.

6. Key Revelations of Season 4

(1) All Titans trace back to Ymir Fritz, a slave girl who discovered a mysterious source of power in a tree two thousand years ago, and her descendants carry the curse. (2) Marley and the Mid-East nations are in a constant struggle, and Eldians are used as weapons. (3) Eren has manipulated events across time through the Paths. (4) The Rumbling was Eren's plan from the start, intended to destroy the outside world and protect Paradis. (5) Eren's real motive was to give his friends the chance to stop him and to end the Titan curse. (6) Mikasa and Armin must choose between loyalty to Eren and the fate of the world.

7. Ending and Aftermath

After the Rumbling ends, the survivors return to their homes. The Titan powers vanish, the Eldians are no longer feared as monsters and the world slowly begins to recover. Armin becomes a peace ambassador and works to prevent more war. The Eldians of Paradis, the Marleyans and the nations of the world must now rebuild trust. Mikasa buries Eren under a tree on a quiet hill, and she visits the grave regularly for the rest of her life. In the closing scenes, long after her death, the world moves on, but a boy finds the tree, suggesting that history may repeat itself.

8. How the Story Progresses

Season 4 begins as a war story told from the enemy's point of view, then becomes a tragedy about hatred and sacrifice. The first half humanises the people the audience feared, while the second half forces the heroes to fight their friend. Instead of a simple victory, the ending shows the cost of freedom and the cycle of violence, and it leaves the viewer with the idea that peace requires understanding, even between people who were taught to hate each other.